

AI-Assisted Software Development

Other AI Developer Assistant Tools

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Summary

- **Aider** (See Appendix)
- **V0** (See Appendix)
- **Windsurf** (See Appendix) (and Maybe Codeium)
- **Claude Code**
- **Bolt.new**
- **Augment Code**
- **Github Copilot**
- **Replit**
- **Others to Consider:**
- **Amazon Code Whisperer**
 - For editing rather than app-creation, Supports many languages
- **IBM WatsonX**
 - Strong data governance, IPR indemnity
 - Library of fine-tuned models eg for code conversion
- **Claude Coder** (from Kodu-ai)
- **Roo-Cline & Roo Code**

Aider

See Appendix for details

- Python app, Installed via `pip`
 - alternatively in a `venv`
- Uses OpenAI and other models (via API keys)
- Works as a terminal command-line app
- Accesses local files
- Can work on entire code base
- Integrates with Git for version control
 - creates commits at each stage
- `/web` command accesses webpages, can scrape
 - Interacts with web pages via Playwright (cf Selenium)
- `/tokens` command !! also shows cost

See Appendix for details

- Generates front-end web apps
- Runs as a web-app
- From Vercel, creators of the Next.js framework for React
- Supports React, Vue, Svelte and HTML/CSS front-ends
- Download generated app as a zip file
 - and follow its installation / run instructions

Windsurf

See Appendix for details

- Dedicated IDE from Codeium.com
- Implemented as a fork of VS Code
- Developed from predecessor: Codeium VS Code extension
 - Some say Codeium performs better
 - Check as an alternative if Windsurf shows limitations
- Autocomplete mode (generate single statements)
- Supercomplete mode (generate blocks of code)
- @ mentions, like Cursor
- Context includes:
 - current file
 - entire codebase (using RAG)
 - git commit history

Claude Code

- Node.js app, install using **npm** or **pnpm** package manager
- Works as a terminal command-line app
- Uses Anthropic API key
- Makes extensive use of Anthropic LLMs, beware of cost
- Agent mode creates and edits local files
 - and creates Git commits
- Chat mode answers questions about your codebase
- Can run headless, eg in scripts
- Supports Model Context Protocol
 - for connections to Databases, APIs, etc
- `/cost` command !!
- To run on Windows it requires WSL

Bolt.new

- Browser-based development environment from StackBlitz
 - Includes preview / deployment environment
 - Download generated app to run locally
- Uses StackBlitz's WebContainer in-browser dev environment
- Generates front-end and backend code
- Supports popular UI frameworks like React, Vue, Angular
- Can automate environment setup and package management
- Includes AI-powered debugging tools
- Uses wide choice of LLMs via API keys
 - Some variants have multi-LLM capability (like Cursor)

Augment Code

- Runs as a VS Code plugin, install from VSCode marketplace
 - Also as plugin for JetBrains or Vim
- Requires a Github or Microsoft or Google login
 - Cant use email address
- Uses a mixture of LLMs based on required capabilities
- Chat, Next Edit and Instruction modes
- Agent creates and edits multiple source files
- Good data privacy
- Good performance, 2-3 times faster than Github Copilot

Github Copilot

- Runs as a VS Code plugin, install from VSCode marketplace
 - or IntelliJ plugin
- In your github.com icon choose `Your Copilot > Setup`
- Originally reasonably good code-completion tool
- Recent (2025Q1) Agent feature attempts similar features to Cursor
- OK for simple projects [`**MB see work05, demo09`]
- Integrates with github workspaces
- Code Citations (for code it finds in Github)
- Choice of LLMs, Copilot team prefer Claude Sonnet
- Free tier is not time-limited (cf Cursor) but only 50 chats per month
 - (2000 code completions)

Replit

- Browser based IDE and deployment environment
 - Easy, but dependent on Replit environment, can't download app
 - could copy / paste from app's files though
- Free tier allows only 3 apps
- Has wide range of templates eg Solar System app
- Changing generated code has limitations